Product Strategy Lead | Built Environment & PropTech Innovation

Adam Bin M Raman

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Nationality: Malaysian |
Location: Sendai, Japan (Open to Relocation / Hybrid / Remote)

Ex-Founder (Scaled to Profitability) | Expert in Human-Centric Design & Process Automation

Professional Summary

Innovation strategist and former Founder with 10+ years of experience bridging the gap between physical infrastructure and digital solutions. Successfully bootstrapped a design-build firm to profitability (100% YoY growth) before pivoting to a Research Sabbatical in Climate Tech. Expert in Human-Centric Design, applying deep user empathy to make complex technical systems (Spaces, Energy, Software) intuitive for humans. Currently leveraging AI-assisted workflows to drive digital transformation and sustainable innovation.

Core Skills & Expertise

- **Design & Innovation:** Human-Centric Design (HCD), Design Thinking, User Experience (UX) in Physical & Digital Spaces, Spatial Planning.
- **Business & Strategy:** Business Development, Product-Market Fit, Deal Sourcing, Market Due Diligence, P&L Management, Startup Evaluation.
- **Technology Focus:** Climate Tech, PropTech, IoT Systems, Smart Homes, Process Automation (Python/Electron), Renewable Energy.
- **Leadership:** Founder Experience, Cross-Border Operations, Strategic Partnerships, Mentorship.

Professional Experience

Building Energy Consultant & Process Automation | Refil *Japan | 2025 – 2026*

Energy Systems Design:
Conducting comprehensive energy audits and designing mechanical/electrical system proposals for new builds, ensuring optimal human comfort and sustainability.

Process Automation:
Developed internal automation tools and custom apps to parse Japanese Industrial Standards (JIS) and streamline regulatory compliance, ensuring consistent deliverables across complex projects.

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Founder, Managing Director & Design Lead | Lakar Design *Malaysia | 2012 – 2022*

Market Disruption:
Pioneered the "affordable designer renovation" model in Malaysia, democratizing high-end design for the middle class. This model was later adopted by competitors, shifting the local industry standard.

Human-Centric Business:
Scaled the company to profitability with 100% Year-on-Year revenue growth for 8 consecutive years by focusing on user experience in physical spaces.

Operational Scale:
Directed 40+ capital projects (Residential, Commercial, & Smart Homes) with full P&L responsibility.
- **Tech Integration:**
Partnered with suppliers to implement innovative construction tech (lightweight structures, fireproof kitchens, IoT smart home systems).

Assistant Lecturer & Facilitator | MARA University of Technology (UiTM) *Malaysia | 2016 – 2019*

Design Principles:
Designed and delivered curriculum modules on "Design Thinking" and "Human Sensibility".

Mentorship:
Mentored 200+ students in integrating construction technology and human-centric methodologies.

Assistant Architect | S&A Architects *Malaysia | 2009 – 2011*

Award-Winning Design:
Lead Designer on a residential estate project that won the **PAM Award 2017** (Multiple Residential Low-Rise).
Project Turnaround:
Revived a 17-storey abandoned housing project, scaling role from interior designer to lead architect to ensure successful delivery.

Education

- **PhD Sabbatical (Climate Tech R&D)** – Tohoku University, Japan (2025)
  Thesis: Conducted R&D on solar-regenerated passive dehumidification, engineering a hardware solution that achieved a maximum 50% reduction in cooling energy load for hot/humid climates.

- **Master of Architecture (Part 2)** – University of Manchester, UK (2011)
  Dissertation: Barriers to Energy Efficiency in Existing Housing Stock.

- **Bachelor of Science in Architecture (Part 1)** – UiTM, Malaysia (2008)

https://linktr.ee/adamraman

Languages & Certifications

- Languages: English (C2), Malay (C2), Japanese (JLPT N3-N2 equivalent).
- Certifications: IELTS Band 8.0 (2021) | RIBA Architect Accredited | LAM Accredited.
- License: Japanese and Malaysian Driving licenses. Malaysia Construction license

Other Experience

- **Cultural Educator | MIA/SenTIA, Sendai (2023 – Present):** Conducts cultural workshops introducing Malaysian culture to Japanese schools and Architects.
- **International Sourcing Specialist | Awatar Ltd, UK (2023 – Present):** Sourcing and global logistics for vinyl records (USA, UK, France).
- **Concert Organizer | KNUKE, Manchester (2010):** Organized concert tours for Malaysian bands in the UK, managing venues, logistics, and partnerships.